

### READING PASSAGE 3

## Volcanic Activity and Human Settlement

**A** The study of volcanic activity and human settlement has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

**B** The origins of contemporary research in this area can be traced to pioneering studies conducted during the mid-twentieth century. These early investigations, though constrained by the technological and methodological limitations of their era, established foundational principles that continue to inform current scholarship. Successive generations of researchers have built upon these foundations, progressively refining theoretical models and expanding the empirical evidence base through increasingly sophisticated research designs.

**C** The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

**D** The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

**E** Despite the substantial progress that has been made, significant challenges and controversies remain. Critics have raised important methodological concerns regarding the generalisability of findings derived from studies conducted in specific contexts. The predominance of research carried out in Western, educated, industrialised, rich, and democratic societies raises questions about the applicability of current theories to populations with different cultural, economic, and political circumstances. Furthermore, the reliance on cross-sectional designs in much of the existing literature limits the capacity to draw strong causal inferences.

**F** The future trajectory of research in this area will likely be shaped by several converging trends. Advances in computational methods and data science are opening up new analytical possibilities, enabling researchers to detect patterns and test hypotheses at scales that were previously unimaginable. Simultaneously, growing recognition of the importance of interdisciplinary collaboration is breaking down traditional barriers between fields and fostering innovative syntheses of diverse theoretical perspectives.

**G** In conclusion, the study of volcanic activity and human settlement represents a vital and dynamic area of contemporary research. The progress that has been made in understanding the key mechanisms and dynamics provides a solid foundation for both further scholarly inquiry and practical application. The challenges that remain should be seen not as reasons for discouragement but as opportunities for continued intellectual growth and social contribution.

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### Question 1

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 1 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

**Question 2**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

**Questions 3–5**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 3 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration
- 4 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration
- 5 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:
- A. excessive research funding
  - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
  - C. lack of public interest
  - D. too many international collaborations

**Question 6**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 6 The passage suggests that structural factors are less important than individual choices.

**Question 7**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 7 The passage identifies power \_\_\_\_\_ as a key factor at the organisational level.

**Question 8**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. weak effects across studies
  - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
  - C. contradictory findings
  - D. results only in specific populations

**Question 9**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 9 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

**Questions 10–11**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.
- 11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

**Question 12**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 12 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?
- A. excessive research funding
  - B. translating academic findings into practical policy
  - C. lack of public interest
  - D. too many international collaborations

**Question 13**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 13 Case studies have documented the effects of \_\_\_\_\_ change on the system.

